

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

SECTION A - Western Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "Aristotle rejects the separation of the Forms, not form itself." Examine this claim. [10 marks]

Model answer (200 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The claim is accurate and is the precise formulation an answer on this topic needs. What he rejects. At Metaphysics I.9 Aristotle argues that separated Forms duplicate what was to be explained, that "participation" is a metaphor rather than an analysis, that a changeless non-spatial entity cannot originate change, and that the theory gives no account of generation. The Third Man regress - stated by Plato at Parmenides 132a-b and named in Aristotle's reports - shows that self-predication plus non-identity multiplies Forms without end. What he retains. Form remains the central explanatory principle: it is the what-it-is-to-be (to ti en einai) of the composite, and at Metaphysics VII (Z).17 substance is sought as a cause, so "why is this matter a house?" is answered by the form. Species and genus survive as secondary substances, and the soul is the form of the living body. Examination. One qualification is needed. By immanentising form Aristotle inherits Plato's hardest problem in new dress: form must be intelligible and hence universal, yet Metaphysics VII (Z).13 denies that any universal is a substance. Verdict: the rejection is of separation, not of form - and inheriting the universals problem is the price of the repair.

(b) "History is a process of dialectical change." In the light of this statement discuss Hegel's approach in understanding history. [10 marks]

Model answer (196 words; practice model, not official): The mechanism, first. For Hegel each historical form embodies a norm of freedom while restricting its application; its own practices therefore expose an internal inadequacy, and later institutions are read as more adequate articulations of the same norm. This is immanent critique in a historical register. The claim. In the posthumously edited lectures, world history is "the progress of the consciousness of freedom". The development is in what a society understands freedom to require, not in an automatic improvement of events. The schema, as illustration only. One is free under Oriental despotism (the Persian and Chinese empires); some are free in the Greek and Roman world, citizens but not slaves (Athenian democracy, Roman law); all are free in principle in the Germanic-Christian world, realised in the modern constitutional state. Cunning of reason. Individuals pursue passions whose consequences exceed their intentions; Caesar and Napoleon are agents of transitions they do not fully comprehend (Enc. 209). Verdict. The mechanism is genuinely explanatory. The stage sequence is a dated Eurocentric hierarchy treating European modernity as the telos; "all are free" states a principle, not an achievement; and the retrospective teleology can rationalise victors and understate contingency, colonialism and exclusion.

(c) "The epoche brackets the world." Examine the accuracy of this formulation. [10 marks]

Model answer (193 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The formulation is close enough to be repeated and wrong enough to lose the topic: what is bracketed is not the world but the positing of its existence. What is bracketed. The general thesis of the natural attitude - the standing positing that the world exists independently of my awareness of it. Ideas I 31-32 describe it as put out of play and placed in brackets. What survives. The stream of consciousness with all its intentional contents; the full descriptive content of what appears - colour, shape, distance, profile, horizon; and the object's presenting itself as the kind of object it presents itself to be. The residue is therefore wider, not narrower, than the field the natural attitude records. Why the loose formula misleads. It suggests removal, and removal invites two further errors: that Husserl doubts the world, which confuses suspension with Cartesian denial; and that the epoche by itself establishes idealism, which runs an operation of method together with a later argued result about constitution. Accurate reformulation. The epoche brackets a validity-claim, never a content; it is a repeatable, reversible change of attitude, and its yield is descriptive richness rather than loss. Qualification.

(d) "That thing is said to be free which exists solely from the necessity of its own nature, and is determined to action by itself alone." Discuss Spinoza's views on freedom and determinism in the light of the above statement. [10 marks]

Model answer (184 words; practice model, not official): The quotation is Ethics I, Definition 7, and its key word is "alone": freedom is contrasted with external compulsion, never with causation. Spinoza therefore rejects freedom as uncaused choice. Every finite mode is determined within Nature's necessary order, and human beings imagine themselves free because they are conscious of their desires but ignorant of the causes that determine them - as a thrown stone would, if conscious, believe it chose to fly. Only God is absolutely free, because only God exists and acts from the divine nature alone, without external determination. Human freedom is relative and achieved. When inadequate ideas and external affects determine us we are passive and in bondage (servitus); when adequate ideas make us the adequate cause of our action, we act from our own understood nature. Reason and intuitive knowledge (scientia intuitiva) therefore convert necessity into self-determination, culminating in the intellectual love of God. The account is coherent but revisionary: it preserves rational agency and emotional liberation while denying alternative possibilities altogether. Verdict. Spinoza reconciles freedom with determinism by making freedom a higher form of determination, not an exception to causation.

(e) Distinguish between senseless (sinnlos) and nonsensical (unsinnig) propositions in the Tractatus, and explain why the distinction matters. Discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (200 words; practice model, not official): Senseless (sinnlos). Tautologies and contradictions are well formed and belong to the symbolism, but they say nothing about the world. A tautology is true under every truth-condition and excludes nothing; a contradiction is false under every truth-condition and excludes everything. They are the limiting cases of proposition-formation, and they show the scaffolding of logic (4.461-4.4611, 6.124). Nonsensical (unsinnig). A metaphysical pseudo-proposition - "the Absolute is perfect", "there are objects" - fails the conditions of sense altogether. It does not depict any possible situation, so it never entered logical space and there is nothing for it to exclude. Why the distinction matters. First, it fixes the status of logic: logical truth is not a body of very general facts but an absence of factual content, which is why "there can be no surprises in logic" (6.1251). Second, it prevents the commonest misreading of the Tractatus. If the two labels were synonyms, Wittgenstein would appear to dismiss logic and metaphysics on one and the same ground, and his position would collapse into the Vienna Circle's verificationism - a criterion he did not hold, since his test is whether a possible situation is depicted, not whether a statement can be empirically checked.

Q2

(a) "Plato's theory of Forms fails not from external attack but from the internal incompatibility of two demands it places on Forms." Critically evaluate. [20 marks]

Model answer (380 words; practice model, not official): The two demands. The theory requires Forms to be separate - hence stable, self-identical, timeless, spaceless and therefore knowable - and simultaneously explanatory - hence involved in making particulars what they are. The claim under evaluation is that these two requirements pull against each other. Evidence that the pressure is internal. Plato states the strongest objections himself. At Parmenides 131a-c the participant must receive either the whole Form, which is then separated from itself, or a part, whereupon a divided Form of Smallness would make its participant large. At 132a-b, if the Form of F is itself F and must differ from what it explains, a further Form follows and the regress begins. Neither argument is imported from a rival school; both arise from the theory's own commitments. Aristotle's contribution. His objections at Metaphysics I.9 - duplication, participation as metaphor, causal impotence, no account of generation - largely systematise this internal pressure rather than introduce a new one. Stace's report of his barb, that the Ideas are "nothing but eternalized things of nature", is a diagnosis of the duplication that separation makes unavoidable. The reply available to Plato. The regress requires self-predication and non-identity; deny self-predication and it weakens sharply, and the whole-or-part dilemma assumes Forms behave like extended bodies, which a spaceless entity does not. Vlastos reads the regress as a strict logical failure, Fine restricts what Plato must concede, and developmental readings see the later dialogues - the Sophist on the communion of kinds, the Timaeus on the Demiurge and Receptacle - as revision rather than abandonment. Whether the objections are resolved is genuinely contested. Where the incompatibility bites hardest. Even granting every reply, the explanatory demand remains unmet: participation still lacks a non-metaphorical analysis. That is why the deepest objection is not the regress but the causal gap - a relation that cannot be specified cannot explain. Verdict. The statement is largely correct but should be graded. The theory does not fail by demonstrated contradiction; it fails to discharge one of the two tasks it set itself, and the failure is internal, since separation was adopted precisely to secure the first task. This is why every later realism about universals keeps the explanatory demand and weakens the separation - which is exactly Aristotle's move, and exactly what leaves him with the universals problem in turn.

(b) "Aristotle's final cause asserts directedness, not design." Discuss with suitable examples, and assess whether teleology survives the objection that it is unscientific. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): The doctrine. The final cause (telos) answers "for the sake of what?" and, in purposive and natural-developmental explanation, has a special priority because it states what the process is for. In natural substances the formal, efficient and final causes typically coincide: the form of oak is both the organising principle of the acorn's development and the end towards which it moves. Directedness, not design. "Nature does nothing in vain" is a recurring Aristotelian maxim, appearing in De Caelo, the Politics and De Partibus Animalium; it asserts regularity of outcome, not deliberation. Nature is not an artisan with a plan. The example of the artefact - the carpenter making a table for dining - is a teaching device drawn from a case where intention really is present; Aristotle's serious cases are organisms, where the directing principle is internal. Example 1 - the acorn. It reliably becomes an oak and never a cat. That reliability is what the final cause names. Example 2 - the eye. Its structure is explained by what seeing requires, not by what a designer intended. The objection. Post-Galilean physics dispensed with final causes and explained motion by efficient causation and law. If physics needs no telos, teleology looks like a superfluous metaphysical overlay. Assessment. The objection is decisive for physics and much weaker elsewhere. Modern biology retained functional explanation under other names - adaptation, selective advantage, the function of an organ - which is directedness without design. The residual worry is real: unless directedness is cashed out independently, "for the sake of" risks describing the outcome and calling it an explanation. Verdict. The final cause survives as an account of the directedness of natural processes towards a mature form; it does not survive as a rival to efficient-causal mechanism.

(c) "Hegel's dialectic is defensible as a description of conceptual breakdown and indefensible as a claim to necessity." Examine this statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (280 words; practice model, not official): What the statement concedes. Taken as description, the dialectic is powerful and unusually economical. It requires no external criterion: a determination is tested only by the claim it makes for itself, and its failure is generated internally. Determinate negation then fixes the successor, so the sequence is not arbitrary, and sublation preserves what was valid, so the movement is cumulative. Applied to the opening of the Science of Logic, the account can be checked with nothing assumed: pure being, having no determination, is indistinguishable from pure nothing, and becoming is the

truth of their inseparability. What the statement denies. The claim to necessity is a different matter. Trendelenburg argues in the *Logische Untersuchungen* (1840) that transition presupposes movement, becoming and time, whereas the categories are static determinations, so Hegel must borrow from intuition the very thing he claims to derive. Hegel's reply is that conceptual instability is not borrowed motion - the "movement" is the self-undermining of a determination that cannot be thought consistently. The reply is available, but it has never been made uncontroversially, and it does not show that the successor is the only possible one. The concession Hegel himself makes. The necessity is visible only retrospectively - "the owl of Minerva spreads its wings only with the falling of the dusk". That protects him from the charge of false prophecy at the cost of conceding what the statement asserts. Verdict. Accurate, with one refinement. The dialectic is defensible exactly to the extent that it is descriptive of conceptual breakdown, and indefensible to the extent that it claims predictive force; between those poles lies a genuine third possibility - retrospective intelligibility - which is weaker than necessity and stronger than mere description.

Q3

(a) "The transition from the Logic to the Philosophy of Nature is the point at which Hegel's system either completes itself or shows its seam." Critically examine. [20 marks]

Model answer (399 words; practice model, not official): The problem, stated exactly. The Science of Logic claims to move by strict internal necessity from Being to the Absolute Idea, with nothing brought in from outside. The Encyclopaedia then passes from Logic to the Philosophy of Nature - from a self-contained order of pure categories to space, time, matter and brute givenness. If the step is necessary, how can a category produce an existent? If it is not, presuppositionless self-grounding collapses at the moment of completion. Hegel's text. At 244 the Absolute Idea "freely releases itself" (*entlat sich frei*) and lets the moment of its particularity go forth as Nature; 247 defines Nature as "the Idea in the form of otherness". Renderings differ, so the should be given and the phrase marked as a rendering. The defensible reading. The release is neither temporal nor causal: there is no "before" in which Logic existed alone, and categories exert no force. It is logical and structural - the Absolute Idea is pure self-relating form, and a form that is nothing but self-relation has no content of its own, so it is its own externality. 250 confirms this by conceding the "impotence of nature" (*die Ohnmacht der Natur*): nature cannot hold fast to the Concept, which is why it teems with contingency. Hegel therefore does not deduce particular natural facts, and the charge that he "deduced the planets" attacks a caricature. The objections. Feuerbach (1839) calls the passage creation ex nihilo with the Creator renamed; Hegel can invert the parallel, holding that Christian Vorstellung pictures narratively what the Logic states conceptually - a reply that works only for those who grant that philosophy translates religion without loss. Analytic critics object that "resolves" and "releases" are verbs of agency applied to a concept; the reply that Hegel's German uses reflexive constructions is correct, but the metaphor cannot be fully cashed out. Schelling, in the Berlin lectures of 1841-2 delivered to an audience including Kierkegaard and Engels, presses the decisive charge: a rational system is "negative philosophy" only - it shows what anything must be if it is, never that anything is. Verdict. The statement is accurate. Read as structure the transition is coherent; read as demonstration it is not, since the necessity is intelligible only retrospectively, from within Nature. Schelling's objection therefore lands, and the post-Hegelian century divides accordingly: Marx keeps the dialectic and drops the Idea, Kierkegaard and Heidegger keep existence and drop the system.

(b) Assess Husserl's claim that free imaginative variation yields knowledge of essences rather than empirical generalisations. [15 marks]

Model answer (291 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The claim stands or falls on a single point - that variation seeks a limit rather than a frequency - and that point is defensible, though it does not make eidetic claims incorrigible. The technique. Begin from a factual instance; vary it freely in imagination in colour, size, material, duration and context; ask at each step whether the phenomenon survives or collapses into something else; what cannot be varied away without destroying it is its essence. Why it is not induction. Induction generalises from many observed cases and yields probability, so further cases strengthen it. Variation is an a priori procedure conducted in imagination, and a single instance suffices to launch it, because what is sought is the point at which the phenomenon ceases to be itself - and no number of further instances makes a limit more secure. The worked case. Vary a triangle's size, orientation, colour and material presentation: the closed three-sided plane-figure structure survives; remove a side and the phenomenon collapses. Note the method's own limit in the same breath: the angle-sum claim holds within a geometrical framework and must not be offered as the invariant of every possible geometry. How the essence is grasped. Essences are seen rather than inferred, in an intuition of essences (*Wesensschau*), whose ancestor is the categorial intuition of the Sixth Logical Investigation - closely related, but not to be collapsed into one unchanged doctrine. Assessment. The strong presupposition is that intellectual seeing is as legitimate as sense-perception, and Ryle and Ayer refuse it, asking how we could know that two subjects intuit the same essence. Husserl's answer is that evidence (*Evidenz*) is the fulfilment of an empty intention, graded and partial, not a feeling of certainty; the operative constraints are counter-variation and intersubjective repeatability. Verdict.

(c) "From the necessity of the divine nature there must follow infinitely many things in infinitely many ways." Explain this statement by Spinoza along with some possible criticisms. [15 marks]

Model answer (252 words; practice model, not official): In Ethics I, P16 Spinoza derives the world from the essence of the one infinite substance. God has infinitely many attributes, each expressing eternal and infinite essence; therefore infinitely many modes follow in infinitely many ways. The relation is immanent causation - P18 makes God the immanent, not the transitive, cause - so modes are in God rather than external products of a transcendent artisan. Four conclusions follow. God does not deliberate between worlds; divine action is necessary. Nothing is genuinely contingent, since P29 denies contingency and reduces it to ignorance of causes. Thought and Extension express the same order under different attributes. And finite beings possess reality as modes, not as independent substances. Because the causation is immanent, the world is not a product standing outside its maker but the determinate self-expression of what God already is. Three criticisms follow, each with a reply. First, necessity threatens divine personality and

worship: a God without choice resembles an impersonal order. Spinoza accepts the consequence and rejects anthropomorphism, but providence and petition are genuinely lost. Second, Hegel's acosmism objection holds that if only substance is real, the finite disappears. Spinoza replies that modes are real as determinate expressions, though not self-subsistent. Third, strict derivation seems to make evil and bondage divine necessities. Spinoza answers that good and evil are relational notions tied to human power, not properties of infinite substance - yet suffering still belongs, unredeemed, to the necessary order. Verdict. P16 gives Spinoza unmatched systematic unity at the price of personality, contingency and robust individuality.

Q4

(a) "Husserl's transcendental phenomenology escapes psychologism only by relocating it." Critically examine. [20 marks]

Model answer (391 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The charge has real force but is not sustained: relocation would require that validity be made in transcendental subjectivity, and constitution is disclosure, not fabrication - though the reply is coherent rather than decisive. What was expelled. The Prolegomena to Pure Logic, Volume I of the Logical Investigations (1900-01), argues that necessary logical laws cannot be derived from merely probable psychological ones; that the ideal content of a judgement is not a feature of the datable act of judging it; that species-relative truth is self-refuting; and that the causal conditions of thinking are not the grounds of validity. The positive result is ideal objectivity: real acts, ideal contents. The charge. After Ideas (1913), all meaning-constitution is located in the transcendental ego. If truth is constituted in transcendental subjectivity, then validity again depends on a subject, and psychologism has returned wearing a transcendental coat. The reply, in three parts. (1) The transcendental ego is not the empirical psyche. The psyche is a mundane object within the world and is bracketed with it; the transcendental ego is the condition under which world and psyche have sense at all. A reduction to it is therefore not a reduction to psychology, and the objection trades on treating "subject" univocally. (2) Constitution is not creation. To say the sense of " $2+2=4$ " is constituted is to say it is disclosed there; the content remains atemporal and objective, and subjectivity is the medium of access, not the source of validity. (3) Objectivity is finally grounded in transcendental intersubjectivity, not in one subject's dispositions. What survives of the charge. Limb (3) transfers the burden to the Fifth Cartesian Meditation, whose ownness-first order - I am constituted first, others through me - is exposed to Schutz's circularity objection (1957): my body is recognised as a body like others' only if I already possess the sense "other". If intersubjectivity is not independently secured, limb (3) cannot carry the weight limb (2) leaves it. Verdict. Psychologism proper is escaped, because nothing in the transcendental account makes logical validity depend on how any mind happens to work. What is not escaped is transcendental idealism, which is a different and weaker charge - and the reason neo-Kantian and analytic critics, with later Heidegger and Merleau-Ponty, remain unconvinced is that they doubt the distinction between disclosure and constitution can bear the weight Husserl places on it.

(b) "Moore's method protects ordinary knowledge at the cost of leaving philosophy without a criterion." Examine this statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (258 words; practice model, not official): What the statement gets right. Moore's defence rests on a comparison of certainties: an argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism it denies. That is a genuinely protective device, and it is effective because a valid argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards. But the comparison requires a scale, and Moore supplies none. He tells us that "I have a body" is more certain than any sceptical premiss; he does not tell us how the comparison is conducted or what would settle a dispute about it. The 1939 lecture concedes the point in its own way by admitting that the premiss cannot be proved, only known. What the statement understates. Two things. First, Moore's method is not merely defensive: the knowing/analysing distinction is a substantive epistemological thesis - that propositional knowledge can be secure while the analysis of its constituents is unfinished - and it has to be argued against, not merely disliked. Second, the absence of a criterion is partly the point. Moore's target is precisely the assumption that a philosophical premiss automatically outranks a perceptual one, and demanding a neutral criterion for the comparison would reinstate the priority he is challenging. The residual. The dispute cannot be closed from within Moore's resources. Later work re-describes propositions like "here is a hand" as framework certainties on which doubt itself depends rather than as ordinary knowledge-claims - a diagnosis that vindicates Moore's practice while abandoning his description of it, and one that belongs to Wittgenstein's later philosophy rather than to Moore. Verdict.

(c) "I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing". Critically discuss Sartre's conception of choice and responsibility in the light of above statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (258 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The sentence states that there is no stance-free relation to a situation, because freedom is not something the for-itself has but what it is. The structural claim. The for-itself (pour-soi) is the nihilating, self-transcending movement that continually surpasses what it is towards what it is not yet. It cannot therefore not take up a relation to its circumstances. Deferral, conformity and "having no option" are ways of relating, and hence choices. Why non-choice is typically bad faith. To present a deferral as an absence of choice is to describe oneself as a thing determined by circumstance - the collapse of transcendence into facticity that Sartre calls bad faith (mauvaise foi). Responsibility. Since the outcome of a non-choice is produced by that non-choice, responsibility is not diminished by passivity. The 1945 lecture adds the universal dimension: "in choosing myself, I choose man" - each choice projects an image of what human beings ought to be, which is the source of anguish (angoisse). Criticism. Is the distinction between choosing-not-to-choose and being genuinely unable to choose real? Structural oppression, coercion and severe illness appear to limit not merely action but the awareness of alternatives, and the universalisability clause sits uneasily with the denial of a priori values - a tension Sartre concedes, and which the unfinished Notebooks for an Ethics was to address. His later Critique of Dialectical Reason (1960) integrates scarcity and seriality. Verdict. Read structurally the claim is strong: no situation converts the for-itself into a thing. Read as practical advice it under-describes constraint, and that is where the criticism bites.

SECTION B - Indian Philosophy

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

(a) Are the Carvakas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (170 words; practice model, not official): The charge. The Carvaka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a universal, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential - and self-defeating - or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Carvaka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference". The replies. Three are available. (i) Vitanda: the Carvaka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty - but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The softened thesis: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield apodictic certainty, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The level-distinction: concede vyavaharika validity, deny the paramarthika - though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Carvaka". Verdict: inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Carvaka may be radical or consistent, but not both.

(b) "If Purusa and Prakrti are two completely independent realities, then no relation between the two is possible." In the light of this statement make a brief presentation of Sankara's criticism of Samkhya dualism. [10 marks]

Model answer (195 words; practice model, not official): The quoted statement isolates Samkhya's contact problem: if the conscious witness is wholly inactive and primordial nature wholly unconscious, no intelligible real relation appears possible, yet evolution, bondage and liberation all presuppose one. Samkhya answers that the relation is mere proximity (sannidhya), not gross contact: nature becomes active in the witness's mere presence. Two analogies support this - a magnet moves iron without deliberative willing, and a clear crystal appears coloured by a nearby flower without itself changing. The first explains activation by presence; the second explains apparent contamination without real change. Samkhya attacks both. Even a magnet exerts force, so if the witness were genuinely like a magnet it would not be wholly inactive. The crystal may explain appearance, but it cannot explain the initiation of the world-process, since a crystal initiates nothing. He adds that an unconscious chief principle cannot be the Upanisadic cause, which is described as conscious and knowing, and that purposive evolution "for the sake of" the witness presupposes intelligence. His conclusion is that the dualism is unstable: it must either collapse toward monism or admit a third mediating principle - a demand for further explanation rather than a refutation by assertion.

(c) Explain the nature and role of Supermind in evolution as per Aurobindo's philosophy. [10 marks]

Model answer (188 words; practice model, not official): Nature. The Supermind, or Truth-Consciousness, is the ontological principle between Existence-Consciousness-Bliss and the lower creation. It knows by identity rather than by representation, and it is the Real-Idea, in which knowledge and creative force are a single act. It holds unity and multiplicity together without contradiction, and it is emphatically not a superior intellect: mind divides, the Supermind is truth-native. Role in evolution. The Supermind functions at both ends of the double arc. In involution it is the first creative poise through which the Absolute descends toward Overmind, Mind, Life and Matter, so what is finally concealed in Matter is supramental truth. In evolution it is therefore what is being recovered: Matter yields Life, Life yields Mind, and because mind is intermediate rather than terminal, the next step is the manifestation of the Supermind in earthly life. Its descent constitutes the third and decisive stage of the triple transformation, in which mind, life and body become instruments of truth-consciousness and the gnostic being appears. Nothing lower will do this work: the Overmind distributes truth into independent powers, so only indivisible truth-consciousness can undo the division that constitutes ignorance.

(d) Does the seed contain the tree? Discuss with reference to Nyaya-Vaisesika Philosophy. [10 marks]

Model answer (177 words; practice model, not official): No - not in the sense the question invites. Nyaya-Vaisesika defends non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkaryavada), also called new beginning (arambhavada): the effect does not pre-exist in its cause. The tree is a genuinely new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions of soil, moisture, warmth and time. The seed is causal ground, not a concealed miniature tree in metaphysical latency. Before the tree arises it has prior non-existence (pragabhava) - a real absence whose counterpositive is the tree - and that absence ends precisely when the tree is produced. A real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence. The expected rejoinder is that only a mango seed yields a mango tree, so something mango-like must already be present. Nyaya agrees with the datum and rejects the inference. Specificity is secured by the definition of cause - the mango seed is the unconditional, invariable antecedent of the mango tree and of nothing else - not by pre-existence. Contrast. Samkhya's pre-existent effect (satkaryavada) treats production as manifestation of what was latent. The dispute is about what causation is for: novelty or manifestation.

(e) Discuss the nature and types of matter according to Nimbarka. [10 marks]

Model answer (172 words; practice model, not official): In Nimbarka's dualistic non-dualism (dvaitadvaita), non-conscious reality (acit) is real, dependent and transformable. Its nature is fixed by the school's governing relation: matter differs from ultimate reality because it is limited, and is non-different because it has no independent existence. It is therefore neither an Advaitic illusion nor a second absolute; it is related to ultimate reality as a power or attribute to its possessor, and creation is a real transformation of the absolute's dependent powers. The standard classification gives three types: ordinary primordial matter (prakṛta), that is material nature and its products; non-prakṛtic substance (aprakṛta), associated with the divine realm or body; and time (kāla). Terminology and the placement of time vary across expositions, so an answer should state the classification it adopts rather than multiply subtypes. Philosophically this secures both halves of the school's name. Because matter is real, the world is not cancelled by liberating knowledge; because it is dependent, its reality does not compete with God's. Liberation therefore preserves individuality

while knowledge is enabled by devotion and grace.

Q6

(a) Differentiate between the Carvakas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of atma. [20 marks]

Model answer (360 words; practice model, not official): Both schools reject the enduring self (atman) of Nyaya and Vedanta, but the rejections are not species of one genus. Carvaka: relocation. The doctrine is conscious body as self (dehatmavada) - caitanya-visistah kayah purusah, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The ground is epistemological: perception alone is a means of valid knowledge (pramana), and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an emergent by-product of the organised elements - as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth, svarga and liberation (moksha) all lapse, and maranam eva apavargah. Buddhism: dissolution. Anatman denies not the transcendence but the substantiality of the self. The person is analysed into five skandhas - rupa, vedana, samjna, samskara, vijnana - with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The ground is ontological and soteriological: pratityasamutpada and ksanikavada leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by santana, the causal stream, with pratisandhana and, in Yogacara, alaya-vijnana bearing bijas. Hence action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth survive without a self, and cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvana) remains the goal. The four differentiating theses. (i) Targets differ: Carvaka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind - and since rupa is itself one of the skandhas, Buddhist analysis refutes the Carvaka body-self by name. (ii) Grounds differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) Aftermaths differ: Carvaka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) Prices differ: Carvaka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation. Verdict: Carvaka denies the self's transcendence while retaining its substantiality; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its moral continuity.

(b) Critically evaluate Carvakas' rejection of Akasa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul. [15 marks]

Model answer (275 words; practice model, not official): Akasa. Most Indian schools admit five elements; Carvaka admits four - earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: akasa "is not perceived but inferred" (Sharma). The Vaisesika reaches it by argument - sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore akasa exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a means of valid knowledge (pramana), that route is closed. Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that akasa is a theoretical posit, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Carvaka accepts the four elements as substances, so he cannot refuse the substance-quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air - a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move. Transmigration. Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Carvaka cuts each: conscious body as self (dehatmavada) makes the self the living body - caitanya-visistah kayah purusah; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; action and moral consequence (karma) and adrstā are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge. Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates. Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production - "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated". Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice - and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

(c) Explain the Samkhya view on three gunas (guna-traya) and their modifications. [15 marks]

Model answer (250 words; practice model, not official): The three qualities (guna) are luminosity (sattva), activity (rajas) and inertia (tamas). They are not three separable substances but three inseparable constitutive tendencies of one primordial nature, present together in every evolute in varying proportion. Luminosity is light, clear and buoyant; its affective tone is pleasure and its function is revelation, clarity and manifestation. Activity is dynamic, restless and projective; its tone is pain and its function is energy, stimulation and movement. Inertia is heavy, obstructive and resistant; its tone is delusion and its function is concealment, resistance and material density. Because character, affective tone and evolutionary function are mapped together, a single triad explains physical constitution, mental state and moral temperament at once - Samkhya's most economical achievement. Their modification (guna-parinama) takes two forms. In equilibrium (samyavastha) the three stand in exact balance and nature is unmanifest (avyakta); here each quality transforms within its own nature, which is homogeneous modification (sarupa-parinama). This preserves the claim that nature is never inert, so that dissolution is not annihilation. When equilibrium is disturbed in the presence of the conscious witness, the qualities enter asymmetrical relations and generate differentiated evolutes: this is heterogeneous modification (virupa-parinama), to which actual cosmological evolution belongs. The disturbance is not a mechanical collision. The witness is inactive, so Samkhya describes only functional activation in proximity. The doctrine is therefore powerful as an account of qualitative variety and weakest exactly at its trigger: what converts homogeneous into heterogeneous modification is presence rather than causation, and Samkhya presses precisely this point.

Q7

(a) "A mango tree is grown out of a mango seed." How will Samkhya system explain this process through their theory of causation by rejecting their rival perspectives? [20 marks]

Model answer (357 words; practice model, not official): Samkhya explains the example by the doctrine that the effect pre-exists in its material cause (satkaryavada), in its specific form as real transformation (parinamavada). The mango tree pre-exists in the mango seed not as a miniature gross tree spatially concealed within it, but as a latent determinate capacity in a material continuum; production is manifestation (abhivyakti) of what is latent, and the effect differs from the cause by state (avastha), not by substance. Five arguments support this. Because a non-entity cannot be produced (asadakaranat), no operation yields oil from sand. Because a determinate material cause is taken up (upadana-grahanat), the cultivator selects a mango seed and not sand. Because everything cannot arise from everything (sarvasambhavabhavat), and non-existence is featureless and therefore indiscriminable, sheer prior absence cannot explain why this seed yields this tree. Because the potent produces only the producible (saktasya sakya-karanat), a potency directed at a determinate effect presupposes that effect as its object. Because the effect has the being of the cause (karana-bhavat), the tree continues the seed's material substance as cloth continues threads. The rivals must now be rejected. Nyaya-Vaisesika holds that the effect is absent beforehand as prior non-existence (pragabhava) and that production is a new beginning; it objects that Samkhya equivocates between the absolutely non-existent and the merely not-yet-existent, and that the whole (avayavin) is a new substance with new properties. Samkhya replies that a not-yet-existent effect must still be something determinate in the cause, else the operation has no terminus, and that new properties are new arrangements (samsthana), not new substances from non-being. Advaita agrees that being does not arise from non-being but makes the transformation apparent (vivartavada); Samkhya replies that an appearance-theory cannot explain why production is selective. Buddhism explains becoming by dependent origination without an enduring material root; Samkhya replies that momentary series cannot ground the observed material continuity of seed and tree. The objection that production becomes pointless is answered by manifestation: effort removes obstruction and supplies conditions rather than creating being. The doctrine is therefore strongest as an argument about determinacy, and remains contestable only where an opponent grounds determinacy in relational potency instead of latent effect.

(b) "Our Yoga is a double movement of ascent and descent." Discuss the above statement in the context of Sri Aurobindo's conception of Integral Yoga. [15 marks]

Model answer (278 words; practice model, not official): The statement compresses the operational core of Integral Yoga. Aurobindo's yoga is not a single upward path but two movements, and the necessity of each is established by the failure of the other taken alone. Ascent is the rising of consciousness from ordinary mentality through the higher planes; the order usually given is Higher Mind, Illumined Mind, Intuition, Overmind and then Supermind. Its achievement is freedom: it releases consciousness from narrow, ego-bound mentality. Descent is the bringing down of what has been realised above into the lower nature. Peace, light, force, wideness and finally supramental truth must enter mind, life and body. Only then is transformation, as distinct from liberation, possible. Why both? Ascent alone may give liberation, illumination or transcendence, yet it can leave the lower nature exactly as it was - a fact the mystical traditions had noticed without solving. Descent alone is not merely inefficient but impossible, since nothing can be brought down that has not first been contacted. The conjunction is therefore required by the structure of the task. The double movement recurs through the triple transformation: psychic emergence permits the first descents, spiritual transformation is the descent of the planes contacted in ascent, and supramental transformation is the descent of the Supermind itself. Throughout, the practitioner's part is preparatory - aspiration, rejection, surrender - while the descent is mediated by the Divine Sakti, which is why the doctrine is not spiritual voluntarism. The statement thus marks Aurobindo's whole distance from world-negating liberation: what rises must return. Its first half is broadly recognisable in the history of mysticism; its second, the claim that such descent can transform the body, remains the most contested element of his philosophy.

(c) Elucidate Naiyayikas view of ordinary and extraordinary perception. Are they justified in accepting that universals are perceived? Discuss. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): Ordinary perception (laukika). Gautama defines perception as cognition produced from sense-object contact (indriyartha-sannikarsa), non-verbal, non-errant and determinate. It runs from an indeterminate (nirvikalpaka) pre-predicative phase to a determinate (savikalpaka) phase such as "this is a blue pot". Six graded contacts explain what can be reached: conjunction for a substance; inherence in what is conjoined for its quality; inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined for the universal in that quality; inherence for sound; inherence in what inheres for sound-ness; and the qualifier-qualified relation for absences. Extraordinary perception (alaukika). Three kinds, distinguished by what supplies the connecting relation. Universal-mediated (samanyalaksana): apprehending an instance of smokeness relates the cognizer to smoke as such, so the kind rather than the sample is given. Cognition-mediated (jñanalaksana): a prior cognition mediates a present perceptual presentation, as when sandalwood is "seen" as fragrant. Yogic (yogaja): perception of subtle, distant, past or future objects by the perfected practitioner. Are they justified about universals? For: determinate perception already presents an individual as qualified by a universal, so the universal is given in the cognition rather than added to it; the third and fifth contacts are constructed precisely to reach universals; and without perceptible kinds, classification and the grasping of concomitance lose their base. Against: critics hold that universal-mediated perception is ad hoc, built to solve induction; Buddhist exclusion theory (apoha) explains classification without a perceived one-in-many; and admitting a perception whose object is not in present contact strains the school's own definition. Verdict. Justified within Nyaya's realist ontology, where universals are genuine categories and the third and fifth contacts are constructed to reach them; not justified for an opponent who has already refused that ontology. The dispute is metaphysical before it is perceptual.

(a) According to Sri Aurobindo, 'the awakening of the psychic being and its gradual prominence over all other parts of the being is the first step in the conscious evolution of man'. Explain and examine. [20 marks]

Model answer (369 words; practice model, not official): Explanation. The psychic being (caitya purusa) is the evolving soul-personality formed around the divine spark and standing behind the surface mind-life-body. It grows through successive lives, gathering the essence of experience, and turns naturally toward truth, beauty, love and the Divine. It must be distinguished from three neighbours: the Self (atman), eternal and immutable; the individual eternal self (jivatman), which presides over the whole line of births without descending into change; and the ego, a provisional construction of mind, life and body. The psychic being is the delegate of the individual eternal self in the evolution - the one term that genuinely evolves. "All other parts of the being" therefore names the surface mind, the vital nature and the physical consciousness, ordinarily organised by ego through desire, memory and habit. Its "gradual prominence" - psychicisation - is the process by which soul-guidance replaces ego-guidance. It is "the first step in conscious evolution" because in man alone evolution can become conscious, and consent requires a true centre from which to consent. The argument for priority is not arbitrary. The ordinary person is governed by surface mind, desire and ego; these are unstable and divisive; the psychic being supplies an inner principle of discernment and sincerity; only on that basis can higher spiritual influx be safely assimilated, since force entering an ego-governed nature magnifies the ego. Psychic transformation therefore precedes spiritual and supramental transformation. Examination. The claim presupposes that something in the individual genuinely evolves while the Self remains free, that inner experience can identify the psychic being, and that the sequence of transformation is fixed. Its strength is economy: the fourfold distinction lets Aurobindo hold together the Advaitic freedom of the Self, the reality of individual centres and genuine growth, which a single term could not do without contradiction. The standard objection is that this multiplies entities; the reply is that immutable witness, unevolving centre and evolving soul cannot be one term. The residual worry is that the scheme looks stipulative unless yogic psychology is accepted as evidence, and that no public criterion distinguishes psychic emergence from refined egoity. The claim is thus defensible within Aurobindo's framework and genuinely first in the order of transformation, while its warrant remains internal to his method.

(b) Discuss the nature and relationship of Jiva and Jiva-saksi according to non-dualism. [15 marks]

Model answer (267 words; practice model, not official): In non-dualism the individual self (jiva) is ultimate reality appearing finite: consciousness delimited or reflected in ignorance (avidya) together with the internal organ, and therefore appearing as a doer, enjoyer and transmigrator. Advaita explains this appearance by three models - limitation (avaccheda-vada, associated with Vacaspati Misra, using pot-space), reflection (pratibimba-vada, associated with Padmapada and the Vivarana line, using the mirrored face), and semblance (abhasa-vada) - which stress plurality, vividness and ontological thinness respectively while converging on one conclusion: individuality lacks ultimate reality. The witness (saksi) is pure witnessing consciousness. It illumines every mental state without being altered by any: pleasure, pain, doubt, memory and desire are witnessed, not essential to it. It is self-luminous (svayam-prakasa) and non-objectifiable, and it is not a passive blank but the condition of all experience. The classical support is the survey of waking (jagrat), dream (svapna) and deep sleep (susupti): the later report "I slept peacefully; I knew nothing" presupposes continuity through a state without object-cognition. The fourth standpoint (turiya) is not a further episode but the consciousness underlying all three. Their relationship is not that of two selves. The witness is the individual's own essential consciousness considered apart from adjuncts; the individual is that same consciousness considered along with them. The apparent relation is therefore due to limiting adjuncts (upadhi), not to a real distinction of substances. In the hierarchy of the 2022 question, the witness stands closest to the ultimate standpoint, the individual belongs to empirical bondage. Critically, the deep-sleep argument establishes an enduring witness more securely than it establishes non-dual identity; Ramanuja and Nyaya accept the first and reject the second.

(c) Explain Buddhist concept of Triratna and their internal relation. Critically examine the consistency of Triratnas with the Buddhist concept of No-soul (Nairatmyavada). [15 marks]

Model answer (260 words; practice model, not official): The Three Jewels (Triratna) are the Buddha, the Dharma and the Sangha, the threefold refuge of the Buddhist practitioner. Internal relation. They form a functional triad rather than three parallel objects of devotion. The Buddha is the one who discovered and demonstrated the path; the Dharma is the teaching and the truth it states, and is what actually liberates; the Sangha is the community that preserves, transmits and exemplifies the teaching. The dependence therefore runs in two directions. In order of origin it is Buddha -> Dharma -> Sangha, since the teaching derives from the awakening and the community from the teaching. In order of access it is Sangha -> Dharma -> Buddha, since a present-day practitioner reaches the teaching through the community that preserved it. What liberates is identified as the Dharma, which is why refuge is not devotion to a person. Consistency with no-self. The objection is immediate: if there is no self, who takes refuge? Buddhism answers that the refuge-taker is the conventional person, a designated person (prajnapti-purusa) upon the five aggregates, not an ultimately real soul. That is all refuge requires, because what is needed is a causal series capable of being conditioned by instruction - and intention and dispositions are themselves aggregates. Far from conflicting, the two doctrines cohere: no-self purifies refuge of ego-metaphysics. Refuge is not the surrender of a soul to a saviour but the reorientation of a stream by a teaching. Critically, the reply relocates the practitioner to conventional truth, so the Advaitic pressure about the unity of the practising subject remains - a cost, not an inconsistency.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS